

companies that use Express for building and maintaining their Web applications.

Key features:

- Makes using Node.js easier and less error-prone
- Good for creating robust APIs
- Makes routing and handling requests and views easier.

There is a massive community of open source developers and enthusiasts working with Express. Its official repository on GitHub is used by 5.5 million developers and has 7.8K forks. There are some pretty great tutorials available online to learn both Node.js and Express. A new version of Express is released every eight months or so, with the latest being v4.17.1.

The community of Node.js lovers is growing, thanks to the value that it brings as a server-side JavaScript based framework. So Express deserves to be in the Top 3 of your list. Although there is a sharp learning curve with Express, as the JavaScript that you use with Node.js is pretty different from what you may be used to deploying on the front-end, the effort will certainly be worth it. If you haven't tried it, now is the time to start.

2. Angular

Angular is the next, more sophisticated version of the previously famous AngularJS. It is a TypeScript based open source Web application framework built and maintained by Google. It is great for creating single-page Web applications and is extremely popular in the open source community. Google, Microsoft, Autodesk, McDonalds, UPS, Upwork, Freelancer and many other big companies use Angular for their Web applications.

Key features:

- Uses TypeScript, which is a superset of JavaScript and enables developing large-scale Web applications

- Development of Web components is much easier with Angular
- Comes with a built-in powerful command-line interface (CLI)
- Uses one-way data binding
- Uses the MVVM (model-view-view-model)

There are over 15.4K forks on the official repository of Angular on GitHub and 28.8K forks on the official repository of its predecessor AngularJS. The community and support for Angular is vast and pretty stable — something that will most likely continue, thanks to Google. There are some really good tutorials and lessons on getting started with Angular, available for free. Google is highly active with releasing versions of Angular. There is a new updated version out almost every week and at the time of writing this article, the latest version is v9.0.0-rc.7.

Angular is certainly an in-demand Web application framework with a lot of potential. It's got some big companies backing it, and you are expected to be good at Angular if you are a professional Web developer. The only drawback is that there is a slightly steep learning curve with TypeScript, which can make Angular look a little intimidating to start with. My recommendation is to get over that little hiccup and learn Angular now!

1. React

The No.1 on my list is React. Built by Facebook, it is a JavaScript library for writing highly reactive single-page Web applications. Unlike Angular, which is a full-fledged framework, React cannot be directly

defined as a framework. While it acts more or less like a library, the underlying concepts of React, such as components, the use of JSX and inversion of control, bring it pretty close to being loosely defined as a framework. Facebook, Instagram, Netflix, Yahoo and Khan Academy are among some of the big names that use React.

Key features:

- Uses JSX, which is a syntax extension for JavaScript that provides support for pseudo HTML coding
- Has a simpler design compared to Angular
- DOM rendering is made easier with the help of components
- Is easier to learn and deploy as compared to Angular

React has a massive open source community, with 2.9 million developers using the official repository on GitHub that has over 27.1K forks. There are hundreds of great resources available to learn React. There is at least one release every month, the latest being v16.12.0.

React is certainly the most promising single-page Web application development library in the market, as of now. As a professional Web developer, it is essential for you to learn React. With projects like React Native gathering momentum, it is pretty clear that React will extend its boundaries and become an even more robust and extensive platform in the near future. It should definitely be on the top of your list. **END** 🐧

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